Rejected and reserved designs

Status: reference. This page records alternatives that were considered and rejected, and code that was removed with the condition for reintroducing it. It is not a roadmap; the roadmap records scheduled work.

Rejected alternatives

Alternative	Why it was rejected	Record
Single-dispatch receiver methods	Multiple dispatch is the only polymorphism: a generic function dispatches on all arguments, so receiver-first lookup would be a second, weaker mechanism. The cell system still gets nominal class dispatch through class specializers inside that one mechanism.	D19, D46, D47
A typeclass or word registry	The dispatcher is a match; a typeclass or registry would add an abstraction over the same table. The image-resident word and generic protocols are the extension points instead.	D19, D21; `docs/evaluator-slicing-and-scheduler.typ`
Ad-hoc overloading or a silent `method_missing` fallback	A missing slot, an unbound slot, a wrong value and an undecidable dispatch are named refusals. A silent fallback would make an unknown case look like a valid one.	D46, D47, D49
A conditional verb body (`Expression.Ite`)	Guarded rows plus a completeness proof keep the implementation fragment small and make the gap/no-overlap claim provable instead of asserted.	D13
A machine-learning decision model inside the verified path	A probability is neither a proof nor a witness, so it cannot enter the proof-or-witness trust boundary. It could only advise outside the verified path.	D13
Lean as the proof backstop	Superseded by D10: Z3 is in-process; Lean remains only a possible optional export.	D10
A reflective tower or an open meta-level	The meta-level is fixed and the class/metaclass closure is finite; the goal is kernel reduction, not a reflective tower.	D16, D17, D49
Physical deletion of image entries	The image is append-only. Opt-in compaction preserves stable addresses; physical deletion remains a non-goal.	D52, D53
`all` as a quantifier	Use `every`; the subject stays singular. `all` is refused with `UnsupportedQuantifier`.	D18
Fable as a browser compile target	Out of scope for now, not rejected on technical grounds: it becomes useful only if the browser deployment is a goal.	Q6

Removed code and reserved names

- `Violations.Witness.ShrunkSentence` was removed because no stage produced it. Reintroduce it when a stage can shrink a failing sentence (for example a parser or discourse witness) and

`Presentation` can render it: add the producer, the presentation line, and a regression test. D62 and D72 record the original intent.

- `Presentation.Rendered` was removed because `render` and `renderTechnical` return strings and no caller needed a structured value. Reintroduce it when the CLI or a UI needs structured output (headline plus details, or JSON), not pre-joined text: add the constructor, the renderer, and the consumer together.
- `Presentation.withNearest` is implemented but only the suite calls it. TODO: wire it into the CLI/demo.
- `Violations.Layer.Discourse` is reserved for a host-provided contradiction. TODO: add a contradiction detector that produces this layer; `Discourse.utter` currently implements only the rollback policy.
- `DecisionTable.explain` is the adapter from a `NoMatch` or `Ambiguous` selection to one `Violation`; `Diagnostics.addSelection` feeds the common sink (D74). The CLI mode is `--table <path>`.
- The Basic English decision-table surface is D74 (`table`, optional `policy:`, transition rows, `end`). It is a document format, not a new sentence grammar. The CLI mode is `--table <path>`.
- Character offsets are implemented as D76: `Violations.parseText` fills `Violation.Span.Start` and `End` from the first surface occurrence; the token-only API stays offset-free.
- The mixed `Repair`/`RepairSearch` model was rejected and replaced as D79: `FixedSpecificationAcceptance` consumes a frozen specification and an implementation proposal, while `NearestSentence` produces advice. The old optional `Patch.SpecEdit` and the string `Violation.Repair` do not exist.

Non-goals, not rejected designs

Bounded mailboxes, distribution, actor priorities, distribution of the scheduler, and the optional DSPy-shaped model layer (D42) are explicit boundaries rather than rejected designs. The implementation, not a hidden feature, is the record. See `docs/commitments-ledger.typ` and `docs/roadmap.typ`.